

Tobias Treppmann

Designer who owns the full loop — writes the brief, designs the flow, prototypes it in code, ships it

CONTACT

LOCATION

Berlin, Germany

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PORTFOLIO

treppmann.design/for/taxfix-ai-first-builder-design

LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
2022 – 2026

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland
2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 – Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching and product-strategy consulting for mission-driven organisations.

PROFILE

I've designed software for fifteen years, and the work I do best is the work with no handoff in it — the brief, the flow, the prototype, the thing that actually ships. I prototype in real code against real APIs, and engineering builds production from it. The last year went into AI running in production rather than AI that demos, in a product where a wrong answer reaches a real person.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (B2C streaming product — iOS, Android, web, connected TV; under 1M users; engineering is external, product managers and product owners in-house, no other designers) · Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- The whole loop, no handoff in the middle — I write the brief, design the flow, prototype it in real code against real APIs, and check the built feature in production. Engineering copies and adapts component structures, API calls and navigation patterns from that prototype into the production app.
- AI is how the loop closes — agentic engineering with Claude Code, introduced here as a design practice. Around 70% of the AI-generated code lands. Iteration went from days to hours. Knowing which of it to throw away is the part that takes judgement.
- AI support copilot, live in production — assistive drafting for viewer letters, emails and social messages, following the handbook's wording and standard phrases. An explicit restricted-topic list sits in the system prompt, and a scope rule suppresses the draft entirely when the input is not a viewer enquiry. It is operated manually and embedded in nothing, so a person has already read the letter before the model sees it and every send decision stays human. Rolled out fully optional, so it had to earn its place on the hard cases.
- AI fundraising system, built solo end to end — performance analysis, prompt architecture, an internal generation prototype, then a production Claude skill whose output ships across in-app notifications, web banners and video scripts.
- The finish, built into the system — a colour-extraction API and config tool of mine, live, driving image-based gradients that hold WCAG contrast in light and dark mode. The detail survives every future screen rather than one screen. Design system as an API underneath it: DTCG tokens, Style Dictionary, multi-platform sync, built without a platform team to inherit it.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — ~50 people, DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) · Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Designer and product manager at once — product management for the main platform plus all product design. I wrote the specs, ran the ticket board engineering worked from, and was the customer-facing contact throughout.
- The decision I defended through the build — inherited a €20k client-funded booking project scoped internally as a standalone add-on module and reframed it into a platform capability, choosing deep integration over the faster standalone module. 70% coordination-time reduction and 90% acceptance at the launch customer, where funerals had to be bookable for and by 20+ cemeteries. It then shipped to the whole customer base as a general booking capability — room rentals, baptisms, weddings.
- AI alt-text in production — shipped for EU accessibility compliance under GDPR plus Protestant and Catholic church data-protection law, across six countries.
- Engineering owned the implementation — the web client in React and the mobile app in React Native were written by the engineers on the team, not by me.

Head of Product Design

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) · Berlin, Germany

- Prompt-to-database onboarding, with the CEO and technical co-founder (freelance, summer 2025) — the AI-generated schema renders into the real data-model editor, not a chat preview, so people can see and correct what the model produced. It became the basis for the public AI beta.
- Research at a scale a team cannot read — Claude over thousands of forum posts for sentiment, pain points and feature requests, with Dovetail as the shared insight repository. Above a few hundred data points that analysis happens or it does not happen at all. Below it I read the responses, because nuance is the first thing a summariser drops.
- Senior Leadership Team, 5 direct reports including a design lead — hired two, promoted two, let two go. Interim Head of Product from July to October 2023.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) · Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Service-to-product transformation — partnered with the executive team to productise the service organisation. Case-by-case support became a standard catalogue.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) · Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Five years of data-dense interfaces where being wrong has consequences — big-data pivot tables, column charts, aggregated JSON views, result cards and filter logic. The hardest was the query-builder preview, where the result you see is a sample and the interface has to be honest about that without becoming unreadable.
- Research inside institutions that make users hard to reach — pioneered iterative usertesting.com screening to get to analysts working inside banks and insurers.
- Led the design team across Germany and NYC for five years — two UX designers reporting to me inside a four-person design org, reporting to the VP Design.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany
UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA
User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA
Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA
Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2008 – 2009 · Düsseldorf, Germany
Freelance Web Designer · 2003 – 2008 · Düsseldorf, Germany
Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2000 – 2003 · Düsseldorf, Germany
E-Commerce Assistant · *Westfalia Werkzeugcompany* · 1999 · Hagen, Germany

SKILLS

Owning the Full Loop

Writing the brief · Designing the flow · Prototyping it in real code · Shipping it · Running the ticket board engineering works from · Customer calls and discovery as the main contact · Verifying the built feature in production and beta

Building with AI

Agentic engineering with Claude Code · Around 70% of AI-generated code landing · Knowing which to reject · Prompt architecture and prompt-to-database interaction patterns · Claude skills running in production · AI-assisted research synthesis over thousands of posts

Prototyping and Engineering Proximity

Real-code prototypes against real APIs · Web, Android and iOS · Engineering adapting prototype code into production across a company boundary · HTML · CSS · TypeScript · SwiftUI · Kotlin · React · Reading the API spec

Craft, and the Part That Shows

Image-based gradients holding WCAG contrast in light and dark · Colour-extraction API and config tool · Data-dense interfaces: pivot tables, filter logic, query-builder previews and sample-based uncertainty · Design system as an API · DTCG tokens · Style Dictionary · Figma Variables · Multi-platform sync

Products Where Being Wrong Matters

Human-in-the-loop by design: the tool is embedded in nothing, so a person reads every letter before the model sees it, an explicit restricted-topic list in the system prompt, the send decision stays human · Analytics for top US, Canadian and UK banks and insurers · GDPR plus Protestant and Catholic church data-protection law across six countries · EU accessibility compliance shipped

Consumer and Multi-Market

B2C streaming across iOS, Android, web and connected TV · Print-on-demand for hundreds of thousands of consumers at Spreadshirt · Behavioural design and habit formation · Multi-country product across DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH and DACH / UK / US · German native, English C2 · Berlin, CET